

Topic 2: Coastal environments

What students need to learn

Key ideas	Detailed content
2.1 Physical processes and human intervention give rise to characteristic coastal landforms	a) Physical processes at work on the coast: marine processes (wave action, erosion, deposition and transportation, including longshore drift), weathering (mechanical, chemical and biological) and mass movement (sliding and slumping). b) Influence of geology, vegetation, people and sea-level changes on coastal environments. (1) c) Role of erosional and depositional processes in the development of landforms: headlands and bays, cliffs, wave-cut platforms, caves, arches, stacks and stumps, beaches, spits and bars. (2)